



Company Profile & Credibility

Fede Analytics — Response to the Financial Intelligence Centre (FIC) Request for Bid: **Azure-Based Analytics Support**

1. Who We Are

Fede Analytics is a **pan-African data, AI, and talent-development consultancy**. We help organisations turn data into an economic asset across three connected disciplines: **data governance**, **AI solution design**, and **accredited training and skills transfer**. Our conviction is simple — value lives in the granularity of data, and organisations that can govern, engineer, and monetise that granularity build durable competitive and operational advantage.

For the FIC, this orientation matters. The FIC's custom analytics solutions on Microsoft Azure are core operational infrastructure supporting its financial-intelligence mandate. Keeping those solutions performant, secure, cost-efficient, and continuously improving is exactly the kind of work our practice is built to do — combining hands-on engineering with governance discipline and structured knowledge transfer so the FIC's own capability grows over the term.

2. How We Work — Four Pillars

Our delivery methodology rests on four integrated pillars. Each maps directly to a dimension of the FIC's requirement.

#	Pillar	What it covers	Relevance to the FIC
01	Data Strategy	Aligning data and analytics investments to measurable business and operational outcomes; prioritising the platforms and use cases that create value.	Ensures support, optimisation, and enhancement work on the FIC estate is directed at the highest-value outcomes, not just ticket closure.
02	Data Engineering, ML & AI	Building and maintaining data pipelines, lakehouse and warehouse platforms, knowledge graphs and ontologies (our deployed Databricks + Neo4j + dbt Ontology Lakehouse), ML/AI models, and Python-based analytics, ETL, and orchestration.	Underpins day-to-day support and maintenance of Azure Databricks, Synapse, ADLS Gen2, MS SQL Server, and Python code in the FIC solutions, and brings relationship-aware, explainable analytics to the financial-intelligence mandate.
03	Data Governance	Structured governance via our CARAT framework, a Data Catalog approach, and securitised / containerised deployment for controlled, auditable, and secure operations.	Directly serves the FIC's security-sensitive, governance-heavy environment and its confidentiality and reporting requirements.
04	Training & Skills Transfer	QCTO / MICT SETA accredited training (accreditation no. 07-QCTO/SDP120426232821), delivered Python-first and hands-on.	Fulfils the RFB's on-demand user-training, adoption, and knowledge-transfer deliverables and reduces long-term dependency on external support.

3. Certifications Behind Our Delivery

Our engineering and platform credibility is evidenced by current, independently verifiable certifications held by our founder and CEO, Samuel Sephiri, and applied directly in delivery. These demonstrate depth across cloud data engineering, streaming and batch analytics, machine learning, and modern lakehouse and LLM delivery — capabilities that transfer directly to supporting the FIC's Azure and Databricks estate. (Named delivery-team certifications are set out in the resource pool and certification index.)

Google Cloud (2021 / 2022):

- Big Data and Machine Learning Fundamentals
- Modernizing Data Lakes and Data Warehouses
- Building Batch Data Pipelines
- Building Resilient Streaming Analytics Systems
- Smart Analytics, Machine Learning, and AI
- Apigee API management

Databricks:

- Accredited Lakehouse Fundamentals — July 2023
- Large Language Models (LLMs): Application through Production — February 2024

Why this matters for the FIC: The Databricks Lakehouse and LLM credentials underpin expert support of **Azure Databricks**, Delta Lake, clusters, jobs, and notebooks. The Google Cloud data-engineering credentials evidence platform-agnostic depth in data lakes/warehouses, batch and streaming pipelines, and ML/AI that transfers directly to **Azure Synapse Analytics**, **ADLS Gen2**, and **Python-based ETL and orchestration**.

4. Proprietary Frameworks

Beyond certifications, Fede Analytics brings proprietary frameworks that structure how we govern data, deliver AI, ground knowledge, and design solutions with users.

Framework	Purpose	Relevance to the FIC
CARAT	Structured methodology for evaluating and elevating data assets across the data-quality and AI-readiness dimensions that matter, within a governed, secure, and auditable operating model.	Provides a repeatable way to keep the data underpinning the FIC solutions fit for purpose, secure, and defensible — aligned to the FIC's security, governance, and reporting requirements.
AI Excellence	Proprietary framework integrating strategy, governance, and technology to design, build, deploy, and scale AI responsibly and to measurable standards.	Ensures enhancements and optimisation of the FIC solutions are delivered responsibly and to consistent, measurable quality.
Ontology / Graph-Knowledge Grounding	Grounding of analytics and AI in ontology and knowledge-graph frameworks — not black-box prompting — for explainable, auditable, semantically-consistent outputs. Realised in our deployed Ontology Lakehouse platform (Azure Databricks + Neo4j + dbt), which models entities, relationships, and meaning over a governed lakehouse.	Makes relationships and networks first-class and queryable — directly relevant to financial-intelligence work (entity resolution, beneficial-ownership and link analysis, typology detection) — with traceable provenance where defensibility matters.
Design Thinking Methodology	Closed-loop, business-process discovery approach that keeps every engagement aligned to business value and ties upskilling to real outcomes.	Improves user adoption and the fit and quality of on-demand enhancement work within the 288-hour cap.

5. Leadership

Fede Analytics is led by **Samuel Sephiri, Co-Founder & Chief Executive Officer** — a data and decision-science leader whose career sits squarely in the large-scale, regulated, financially-sensitive environments that mirror the FIC's operating context.

Executive and industry experience:

- **Head of Decision Science (Fintech), MTN** — leading decision science for a continental fintech business.
- Senior data and analytics leadership at **Mr Price** and **FNB** — retail and banking at scale, under regulatory rigour.

Education:

- **MBA**, Henley Business School (2020–2023)
- **BSc Honours, Computational & Applied Mathematics**, University of the Witwatersrand (2006)
- **BSc, Mathematical Science**, University of the Witwatersrand (2005)

Demonstrated impact:

- Built the **machine-learning credit-scoring capability behind MTN MoMo Advance**, recognised at the **2022 Digital Impact Awards Africa** (Diamond award; Financial Inclusion Excellence).
- Delivered approximately **\$350m in business impact** from big data, AI, and ML initiatives at MTN, including approximately **\$250m realised through insourcing** — evidence of building durable, cost-reducing in-house capability rather than perpetual external dependency.

Why this matters for the FIC: This is leadership grounded in fintech, banking, and telecommunications — sectors with the same regulatory scrutiny, data sensitivity, and operational-reliability expectations as the FIC. The insourcing track record aligns directly with the RFB's emphasis on knowledge transfer and reducing long-term reliance on external support.

6. Reach & Skills-Transfer Track Record

Fede Analytics has trained **600+ full-time employees across seven countries** — **Ghana, Nigeria, Uganda, Zambia, Rwanda, Cameroon, and Iran**. This demonstrates repeatable, scaled capability-building: the same discipline we would apply to the FIC's on-demand user-training, adoption, and knowledge-transfer deliverables, so that FIC staff progressively take on more of the platform's day-to-day operation.

7. Credentials Summary

- **QCTO / MICT SETA accredited training provider** — accreditation no. **07-QCTO/SDP120426232821**.
- **15+ years of founder experience** across banking, fintech, and telecommunications.
- **Pan-African delivery** across seven countries with 600+ FTEs trained.
- **Certified** across Databricks (Lakehouse, LLMs) and Google Cloud (data engineering, batch/streaming analytics, ML/AI, API management).
- **Proprietary frameworks** — CARAT (governance), AI Excellence, Ontology / Graph-Knowledge Grounding, Design Thinking.
- **Deployed Ontology Lakehouse platform** — an agnostic, open-format architecture integrating **Azure Databricks + Neo4j + dbt** for ontology-driven knowledge graphs.

8. Why This Credibility Fits the FIC's Needs

The FIC needs...	Fede Analytics brings...
Expert support of Azure Databricks (clusters, jobs, notebooks, Delta Lake)	Accredited Databricks Lakehouse and LLM certifications and daily lakehouse delivery experience.
Support of Azure Synapse, ADLS Gen2, MS SQL Server, and Python ETL/orchestration	Google Cloud data-engineering credentials and the Data Engineering / ML & AI pillar, transferable directly to the Azure stack.

The FIC needs...	Fede Analytics brings...
Governance and security for sensitive financial-intelligence systems	The CARAT governance framework, Data Catalog approach, and securitised / containerised deployment practices.
Relationship-aware, explainable analytics for financial intelligence (entity resolution, network/link analysis)	A deployed, agnostic Ontology Lakehouse (Azure Databricks + Neo4j + dbt) grounding analytics in ontology and knowledge graphs for traceable, defensible outputs.
Skills transfer, adoption, and knowledge transfer	QCTO / MICT SETA accredited, Python-first, hands-on training with a 600+ FTE, seven-country delivery record.
Leadership that understands the stakes	A CEO with fintech/banking/telco decision-science leadership and a measurable insourcing and impact track record.

9. Azure Accreditation

Fede Analytics holds current, verifiable Azure analytics accreditation:

- **Databricks Accredited Lakehouse** — analytics specialisation on Microsoft Azure (cloud-agnostic; equally accredited on Azure, AWS, and Google Cloud). Verify: credentials.databricks.com/fc84a68a-ca1b-4792-b06e-df6c8e44719d
- **Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)** — Credential ID BEED288501CC72EA (Rendani Tshivhangani).

